ANCHOR STUDIO 1.4.3 BY A. MAMDOUH KASTOUR · BUILD GUIDE

Get the double-click apps for Windows and macOS

A. Mamdouh Kastour's Scholarly Anchor · Amira Mamdouh Kastour · October 2026 · about 15 minutes of your time plus 30–60 minutes of waiting



In tribute to my father,
Mamdouh Kastour (1950–2020)

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1. What you get

File	For	What the user does
ANCHOR-Studio-1.4.3-Windows-Setup.exe	Windows 10/11. R and all packages included; installs without admin rights; Start-menu and desktop shortcuts	Double-click, Next, Finish
ANCHOR-Studio-1.4.3-Windows-Portable.zip	Windows, for USB sticks or locked-down PCs; nothing is installed	Unzip, then double-click `Start ANCHOR Studio.bat`
ANCHOR-Studio-1.4.3-macOS-arm64.dmg	Macs with Apple silicon (M1–M4). All packages included, plus the R installer, which runs once if needed	Drag to Applications, then open
ANCHOR-Studio-1.4.3-macOS-x86_64.dmg	Macs with an Intel processor	Same as above

The app opens in its own window. On Windows this uses Edge in app mode; on a Mac, Chrome or Edge in app mode, otherwise Safari. It stops by itself about 20 seconds after the window is closed. Each file is about 150–300 MB, because it carries R and around 150 R packages.

2. Why GitHub builds them

A Windows app has to be assembled on Windows, and a Mac app on a Mac. GitHub Actions lends you both kinds of machine for free. The kit contains the complete recipe. GitHub downloads R and every package from CRAN, assembles the app, **tests it** (all 39 analyses, PDF reading, report export, and app start-up), and only then packages it. If any test fails, no file is produced, so a broken app never gets out.

3. Step by step

1. **Create a free GitHub account** at `github.com/signup` (skip this if you have one).

2. **Create a repository:** click + > *New repository*, name it `anchor-studio` and choose **Public**. Public repositories get the build machines free, without limits. A private repository also works, but uses your monthly free minutes, and Mac minutes count ten times. The kit contains no article PDF, and `.gitignore` blocks PDFs, so publishing the code is safe.

3. **Upload the kit:** unzip `ANCHOR-Studio-build-kit.zip`. On the new repository's page, click *uploading an existing file*. Drag **everything inside** the unzipped folder into the browser, then click *Commit changes*.
   On a Mac, first press `Cmd + Shift + .` in Finder so the hidden `.github` folder and the `.gitattributes` and `.gitignore` files are shown and uploaded too.
   Check: the repository must now show a `.github` folder. If it does not, click *Add file* > *Create new file*, type the name `.github/workflows/build.yml`, paste the contents of `build/github-workflow-copy.yml`, and commit.

4. **Start the build:** open the *Actions* tab. If asked, click *I understand my workflows, go ahead and enable them*. Choose **Build ANCHOR Studio apps**, then **Run workflow**, then the green **Run workflow** button.

5. **Wait 30–60 minutes.** Three jobs run side by side: Windows, macOS arm64 and macOS x86_64. You can close the browser in the meantime. A green tick means a job is done.

6. **Download:** open the finished run and scroll down to *Artifacts*. There are three downloads, each a zip containing the installer. Artifacts are kept for 90 days.

7. **Optional, a permanent download link:** go to *Releases* > *Draft a new release*, type the tag `v1.4.3`, choose *Create new tag*, then *Publish release*. The build runs again and attaches all four files to the release page. That page's link can go into your QR code or handout, and anyone can download from it without a GitHub account.

4. What is inside each installer

Each installer carries the GPL-3 licence, a NOTICE file, and a list of every bundled R package with its version and licence (THIRD-PARTY-LICENSES.txt). The Windows installer shows the licence before installing. Keep these files when you share the installers: they are what makes redistributing R and bibliometrix lawful.

Version 1.3.0 added the statistics packages behind the Data & methods step (fixest, sandwich, lmtest, metafor, nlme, lavaan), so each installer is about 15 MB larger. Version 1.4.x adds no new packages: its OpenAlex, SEC EDGAR, IMF, ROR and ORCID connectors use openalexR and httr2, which were already included. The data sources are named, with their terms, in NOTICE.md.

5. If a job fails

Click the red job and open the failed step. Copy the last 30–50 lines and send them to me in this chat; I will fix the recipe. Re-running is free: click *Re-run failed jobs*. This is the most likely first-run problem: GitHub retires machine

types over time. If a Mac job reports that `macos-15-intel` or `macos-14` is unavailable, edit `.github/workflows/build.yml` and change that line to the current label listed at `docs.github.com` under "GitHub-hosted runners".

6. Faster alternative

If you connect GitHub to Claude (Settings > Connectors > GitHub) and tell me the repository name, I can upload the kit, start the build, watch it, fix any failure and give you the links.

7. What the first start looks like for users

System	First start
Windows	SmartScreen says "Windows protected your PC", because the app is not code-signed. Click *More info*, then *Run anyway*, once. Then use ANCHOR Studio from the Start menu.
macOS 15 or newer	"Apple could not verify…": click *Done*, then go to System Settings > Privacy & Security and click *Open Anyway*, once. If the R version the app needs is missing, the app offers to install it alongside any R already on the Mac; your default R version stays the default. This asks for the Mac password once.
macOS 14 or older	Right-click the app, choose *Open*, then *Open*. The same R step applies as above.

The build files were checked here (workflow lint, shell-script lint, R syntax, and the smoke test and launcher on Linux). The Windows and Mac builds themselves can only run on GitHub's machines, so the first real test is your first run.